VERBAL

Critical Reasoning

(Strengthening, Weakening & Wrong assumptions)

Assignment 01

hitbullseye

DIRECTION for the question: *Answer the question based on the information given in the passage.*

Question No. : 1

Ross: The profitability of Company X, restored to private ownership five years ago, is clear evidence that businesses will always fare better under private than under public ownership.

Julia: Wrong. A close look at the records shows that X has been profitable since the appointment of a first-class manager, which happened while X was still in the pubic sector.

Which of the following best describes the weak point in Ross's claim on which Julia's response focuses?

A) The evidence Ross cites comes from only a single observed case, that of Company X
B) The profitability of Company X might be only temporary
C) Ross's statement leaves open the possibility that the cause he cites came after the effect he attributes to it
D) No mention is made of companies that are partly government owned and partly privately owned

DIRECTION for the question: *Answer the question based on the information given in the passage.*

Question No. : 2

Amrita Pritam's writing inspired the next generation of modernist Punjabi writers and poets. Most experts regard Pritam as an example of modernist Punjabi writing, there are some who dispute this fact. These experts say that such a description is not justified and Pritams's work is "too often evaluated and observed from a modern point of view".

Which one of the following conclusions is supported by the argument above?

A) Amrita Pritam's work is very controversial B) Amrita Pritam was the pioneer of modern Punjabi writing
C) Amrita Pritam's work helped develop modern Punjabi writing
D) Modern Punjabi writing does not owe as much to Amrita Pritam as many experts make it out to be

DIRECTION for the question: *Answer the question based on the information given in the passage.*

Question No. : 3

Franklin D. Roosevelt (1882-1945) was the well-known President of the United States who was confined to a wheelchair. Usually people who have to depend on a wheelchair to move around find it difficult to be socially active. But despite his disability he was able to carry out his presidential duties. He was a great man in that he did not live a life of excuses, but rather did whatever he felt had to be done. He was willing to make every effort to overcome his disability. Those, who even from the depths of adversity are able to reach heights that ordinary people would never aspire to, all have something in common.

What can be inferred as the common attribute of the people who faced adversities?

A) They all aspire to reach greater heights than ordinary people
B) They have high self-esteem and do not seek other people's help C) They never bemoan their fate and accept it
D) They understand all the important lessons in life

DIRECTION for the question: *Answer the question based on the information given in the passage.*

Question No. : 4

The likes of Venkat Rangan are a self-confident and brave breed: they dare to *act on* what they feel is right. They don't seek validation or approval from customers or investors for their visionary idea, and they tend to ignore naysayers. They know intuitively what the right solution for an unmet market need is. Only after they have introduced their pioneering solution do others recognise its true value.

Which of the following can be inferred from the above paragraph?

A) Harsh conditions of the emerging markets kindle innovators to create products which have a strong research backup
B) The unpredictability of the market makes innovators come up with solutions which are way off the target
C) Innovators valiantly forge their way into unchartered territory using the heart as the compass
D) Innovators rely on analysis and logic when introducing new products in the market

DIRECTION for the question: *Answer the question based on the information given in the passage.*

Question No. : 5

Quality of life is a broad concept, of which happiness forms only a part. Often the term refers to quality of the living environment. Ecologists employ the phrase when appealing against environmental degradation; sociologists speak of it when evaluating a society. The term also denotes how well people cope, and is commonly used in therapeutic professions. Medical doctors refer to quality of life as the restored ability to work and love, while in psychological discourse, the term refers to mental propensities, such as realism and vitality. Still another characterizes the quality of life in terms of its outcomes; products and enjoyment. Products are what life leaves behind – in socio-cultural terms, a contribution to the human heritage, but from a purely biological perspective, procreation, for otherwise the evolutionary mission ends in failure. As for enjoyment, the focus is on personal experience of life, and it is in this sense that happiness is subsumed.

Which of the following can be inferred from the paragraph above?

A) One can say that though quality of life may be defined in different terms by experts from various fields, it's basically the idea of happiness only that's taken as quality of life
B) Some experts equate external conditions with quality of life itself, while others describe the prerequisites for a good life as quality of life
C) Experts are completely divided in their assessment of quality of life and hence a layman discounts the importance of happiness to quality of life
D) Explaining happiness can be very tenuous which has led experts to come up with convoluted explanations of its significance

DIRECTION for the question: *Answer the question based on the information given in the passage.*

Question No. : 6

A star party is a gathering of amateur astronomers to observe the night sky. Such parties may last for a night or extend over a week. The larger star parties can attract hundreds or even thousands of participants. Regional star parties are now held annually and form a part of amateur astronomy. It is important to choose a proper location for a star party. Ideally, the location should offer a dark sky unpolluted with city lights. The sheer thrill of meeting like-minded enthusiasts with varieties of telescopes and binoculars offering spectacular views of constellations, stars, nebulae, planets, comets and deep sky objects makes a star party worth attending. It is common to organize popular lectures, contests, sight-seeing tours, raffles and exhibitions of home-built telescopes at some of the larger star parties. Such events also attract commercial vendors who use the opportunity to meet potential customers. The ambience is that of fun, camaraderie and learning, all under the magnificent canopy of the enchanting night sky.

Which of the following can be inferred from the above paragraph?

A) A dark night is essential for amateur astronomers to be able to observe the constellations
B) City lights hamper the observation of the spectacular view of the night sky
C) Star parties are excellent for amateur astronomers to learn from professional astronomers
D) The only requirement for observation of the spectacular night sky is a dark unpolluted sky

DIRECTION for the question: *Answer the question based on the information given in the passage.*

Question No. : 7

Spirit Airlines inspires a special kind of wrath among the American traveling public: It's the industry leader in customer complaints by a wide margin. In spite of the rancor it inspires, Spirit has become the most profitable U.S. airline in terms of its operating margin and return on invested capital. "Customer complaints generally have a loose but inverse negative correlation to return on invested capital," Wolfe Research analyst Hunter Keay says, noting that well-liked Jet Blue, Virgin America, and Southwest Airlines lag financially.

What conclusion can we draw from the above paragraph?

A) There really does not need to be a service component attached to consuming airfare.
B) The commitment to make the customer happy costs money.
C) Plenty of people think that saving $100 or more is worth a little temporary indignity.
D) Spirit needs to help customers learn about how to fly Spirit to go where they want and keep more money in their pocket.

DIRECTION for the question: *Answer the question based on the information given in the passage.*

Question No. : 8

Fear of flying has become the archetypal modern phobia, the focal point of our discomforts about technology, about the pace of contemporary life, about ceding control to forces unseen and barely understood. While flying remains the safest form of transport, our atavistic brains are densely resistant to the force of statistics, and it's hard to believe that anything other than some dark magic is lifting these 500-tonne metal monsters into the sky. Flying is a magnet for our vulnerability, for our fear of death, for our existential panic, and every story of metal fatigue, clear-air turbulence and engine failure merely serves to confirm our sense of flight as unnatural, uncomfortable and, eventually, catastrophic.

Which of the following can be inferred or deduced from the paragraph above?

I. Air travel is the least unsafe form of travel.
II. Transportation through road is riskier than flying.
III. Fear of flying is actually exacerbated by our own existential fears.
IV. Human beings can be affected by irrational biases, even though there might be statistical evidence to counter the same.

A) I, II and III B) II, III and IV C) I, III and IV D) All of the Above

DIRECTION for the question: *Answer the question based on the information given in the passage.*

Question No. : 9

The definition of truth and falsehood lies strictly outside our general subject, namely the analysis of mind. From the psychological standpoint, there may be different kinds of belief, and different degrees of certainty, but there cannot be any purely psychological means of distinguishing between true and false beliefs. A belief is rendered true or false by relation to a fact, which may lie outside the experience of the person entertaining the belief. Truth and falsehood, except in the case of beliefs about our own minds, depend upon the relations of mental occurrences to outside things, and thus take us beyond the analysis of mental occurrences as they are in themselves.

Which one of the following can be deduced from the paragraph above?

A) truth and falsehood is absolute B) truth and falsehood is not driven by individual beliefs
C) truth and falsehood is limited to the mind of a single individual only
D) factual verification of beliefs is the testimony to their true or false nature

DIRECTION for the question: *Answer the question based on the information given in the passage.*

Question No. : 10

The state of Punjab has been generally self-sufficient in both wheat as well as meat production. With the increase in per capita income in the state, Punjab has seen an increase in the consumption of meat. For producing a pound of meat, 5 pounds of wheat are required. With the state already using all of its land available to produce wheat, and with the increase in income, it can only be predicted that Punjab will have to import wheat at some point of time in order to keep with its meat and wheat demand.

Which of the following is an assumption of the argument above?

A) The total land being used for wheat production will not decrease
B) The population of the state will not remain the same
C) The per capita consumption of meat is roughly the same as the per capita consumption of wheat
D) The consumption of wheat, other than what is used for meat production, will not decrease

QNo:- 1 ,Correct Answer:- *C*

Explanation:-
According to Ross, the profitability (effect) is due to the company moving from public ownership to private ownership (cause).
Julia states that the company was profitable ever since the appointment of the first-class manager, which happened while the company X was still a public sector company.
Thus Julia is focussing on the reason why the company should be profitable, which is mentioned in ***option C****.*

Option A eliminated as Julia's response does not address any issue related to other companies.
Option B is eliminated as Ross does not talk of how long profitability lasts. He only attributes it to private ownership.
Option D is eliminated as no mention is made of partly owned companies.

QNo:- 2 ,Correct Answer:- *C*

Explanation:-
This is a tricky problem where you have to be careful about the conclusion you derive.
Remember the dispute in the argument is whether Amrita Pritam is a modernist Punjabi writer or not.
This means that options A, B and D cannot be conclusively proven from the facts given (as the dispute is around the facts put forward by these options).
Option C *is the correct choice as her influence on Punjabi writing has not been questioned.*

QNo:- 3 ,Correct Answer:- *C*

Explanation:-
Statement C is correct *as it correctly sums up the example given about FDR.*
Statement A mentions "all". It is not necessarily true that all people who face adversity will reach great heights. Hence, incorrect.
Statement B is also not correct because it may not be true is every case.
Statement D also gets ruled out because it is not possible that they'll learn ALL the lessons in life.

QNo:- 4 ,Correct Answer:- *C*

Explanation:-
The paragraph states that the innovators act on what they feel is right which would mean more on intuition than on concrete data or research.
Hence we can infer that they use their heart and as ***they come up with pioneering solutions they would coming with solution which would cover unchartered territory.***
Options A and D are incorrect because they talk about people like Venkat Rangan as people who do what they feel is right and come up with unique solutions.
Option B is incorrect as the innovators actually come up with products or solutions which are of value, but this fact is understood later on by the market.

QNo:- 5 ,Correct Answer:- *B*

Explanation:-
The paragraph in the first few lines states that happiness is dependent on the living environment – external conditions. Later it talks about mental propensities and physical health – which are required if one needs to have a good life. Hence ***option B*** *is correct.*
Option A. The first sentence of the passage makes this statement incorrect, as it states that happiness is only a part when determining quality of life.
Option C. Though the first part is true - that each field expert has his/her opinion - whether a common man will discount happiness or not cannot be understood.
Option D. Quality of life and not happiness is being described here. Also, use of term 'convoluted' isn't warranted by the passage

QNo:- 6 ,Correct Answer:- *B*

Explanation:-
The passage states that the location of the star party should be a location which offers a dark sky unpolluted by sky lights which means that city lights would be troublesome to star gazers.
Hence we can infer that ***city lights hamper the observation of the night sky.***

Option A. Only a dark night is not enough, one needs a proper location, without the obstruction by city lights.
Option C. No mention of professional astronomers in the paragraph
Option D. The word only rules this out. A dark sky unpolluted by city lights is the requirement

QNo:- 7 ,Correct Answer:- *B*

Explanation:-
Option B
The answer is actually given in this line - 'Customer complaints generally have a loose but inverse negative correlation to return on invested capital.', which when translated into layman's language means that you can either make profits or keep customers happy.

Option A – This is the philosophy of Spirit, but not the conclusion of the passage.
Option C – This is the rationale of the Spirit customers, but again not the conclusion.
Option D – This may be a future action plan by Spirit's marketing department.

QNo:- 8 ,Correct Answer:- *D*

Explanation:-
In this case, ***all the statements can be inferred from the paragraph****.*
We know that flying is the safest mode (given in the paragraph) and therefore, air travel is the least unsafe form of travel. (Remember, the double negatives eliminate each other).
Refer lines
For I,II, IV - "While flying remains the ***safest form*** *of transport,* ***our atavistic brains are densely resistant to the force of statistics, "***
For III - "Flying is a magnet for our vulnerability, for our fear of death, for our ***existential pani****c,...."*

QNo:- 9 ,Correct Answer:- *D*

Explanation:-
Option A may not be true in all the cases, especially when there is no factual co-relation for truth and falsehood.
Option B negates the paragraph itself.
The case presented in option C may not be correct as universal facts might lead to universal truths and falsehoods (thus proving that truth and falsehood are not limited to one single individual).

Option D *is essentially deduced from the lines: A belief is rendered true or false by relation to a fact, which may lie outside the experience of the person entertaining the belief.*

QNo:- 10 ,Correct Answer:- *D*

Explanation:-
In the given case, the conclusion is that Punjab will need to import wheat as the consumption of wheat (due to an increase in meat consumption) will continue to increase.
Now what if the consumption of wheat (other than for meat purposes) goes down?
Does Punjab then need to import wheat? No, it does not.
The given conclusion is only valid if the overall consumption of wheat remains same and this is taken care by the assumption put forward by ***option D.***

(Remember, the area under cultivation or population do not impact the conclusion; only the consumption figures do).